Android Bundling Issue Report Card

App: Patient Status: Resolved

Reported issue

Android bundling failed with:

```
TypeError: Cannot read properties of undefined (reading 'transformFile')
```

The error occurred in Metro while it was trying to transform the app entry file.

Root cause

Metro had failed to initialize its transformer. The underlying configuration issues were:

1. babel-preset-expo was used by Babel but was not declared as a direct patient-app dependency, so it could not be resolved from the app.
2. NativeWind's Babel integration was configured as a plugin instead of a preset.
3. Metro was configured to use global.css, but that file did not exist.

Resolution

- Added the Expo-matched babel-preset-expo dependency and updated the patient app lockfile.
- Moved nativewind/babel into the Babel presets list.
- Added global.css with the Tailwind directives and imported it from index.ts.
- Declared CSS imports for TypeScript.

Step-by-step fix

Run commands from the patient app directory:

```
Set-Location 'C:\Users\lenovo\Desktop\doctor-appointment-platform\apps\patient'
npm install --save-dev 'babel-preset-expo@~57.0.14'
```

Use an Expo SDK-compatible preset version. For this project, Expo is ~57.0.27 and the matching Babel preset range is ~57.0.14.

In babel.config.js, configure NativeWind as a preset, not a plugin:

```
module.exports = function (api) {
  api.cache(true);

  return {
    presets: [
      ["babel-preset-expo", { jsxImportSource: "nativewind" }],
      "nativewind/babel",
    ],
  };
};
```

Make sure metro.config.js points to the stylesheet:

```
const { getDefaultConfig } = require("expo/metro-config");
const { withNativeWind } = require("nativewind/metro");

const config = getDefaultConfig(__dirname);

module.exports = withNativeWind(config, { input: "./global.css" });
```

Create global.css in the app directory:

```
@tailwind base;
@tailwind components;
@tailwind utilities;
```

Import it at the top of index.ts:

```
import "./global.css";
```

If TypeScript reports that it cannot find declarations for the CSS import, add this to nativewind-env.d.ts:

```
/// <reference types="nativewind/types" />

declare module "*.css";
```

Finally, reinstall dependencies if needed and verify both the Android bundle and types:

```
npm install
npx expo export --platform android
npx tsc --noEmit
```

Verification

- npx expo export --platform android — passed; Android bundle generated.
- npx tsc --noEmit — passed.

Lessons learned

- A Metro transformFile error can be a secondary symptom: check the earlier Metro output for a transformer initialization error before changing Metro internals.
- Babel presets referenced by the app should be declared directly in that app's dependencies, with versions compatible with its Expo SDK.
- Follow the installed NativeWind version's setup convention; for this app, nativewind/babel belongs in presets.
- Keep Metro's configured stylesheet path in sync with a real CSS entrypoint, and import that stylesheet from the app entry file.
- After changing bundler configuration, validate with a production platform export as well as the TypeScript check.

If the error happens again

1. Run the Android export from the patient app directory to expose the first underlying transformer or Babel error:

powershell Set-Location 'C:\Users\lenovo\Desktop\doctor-appointment-platform\apps\patient' npx expo export --platform android

2. If the log says Cannot find module 'babel-preset-expo', confirm it is declared in apps/patient/package.json at a version compatible with Expo, then run npm install from that directory.
3. If Babel reports an invalid plugin/preset property, compare babel.config.js with the installed NativeWind version's setup and ensure nativewind/babel is listed under presets.
4. If the configured CSS input cannot be found, ensure global.css exists at the path in metro.config.js and is imported from index.ts.
5. Re-run npx expo export --platform android and npx tsc --noEmit. Avoid editing Metro internals: fix the first actionable configuration error in the log.